

Denali 2022!

May 26 – June 11





DENALI SUMMIT

6,190m/20,310ft

Ridge
4'900m

Fixed ropes

17k CAMP 5
5,240m/17,200ft

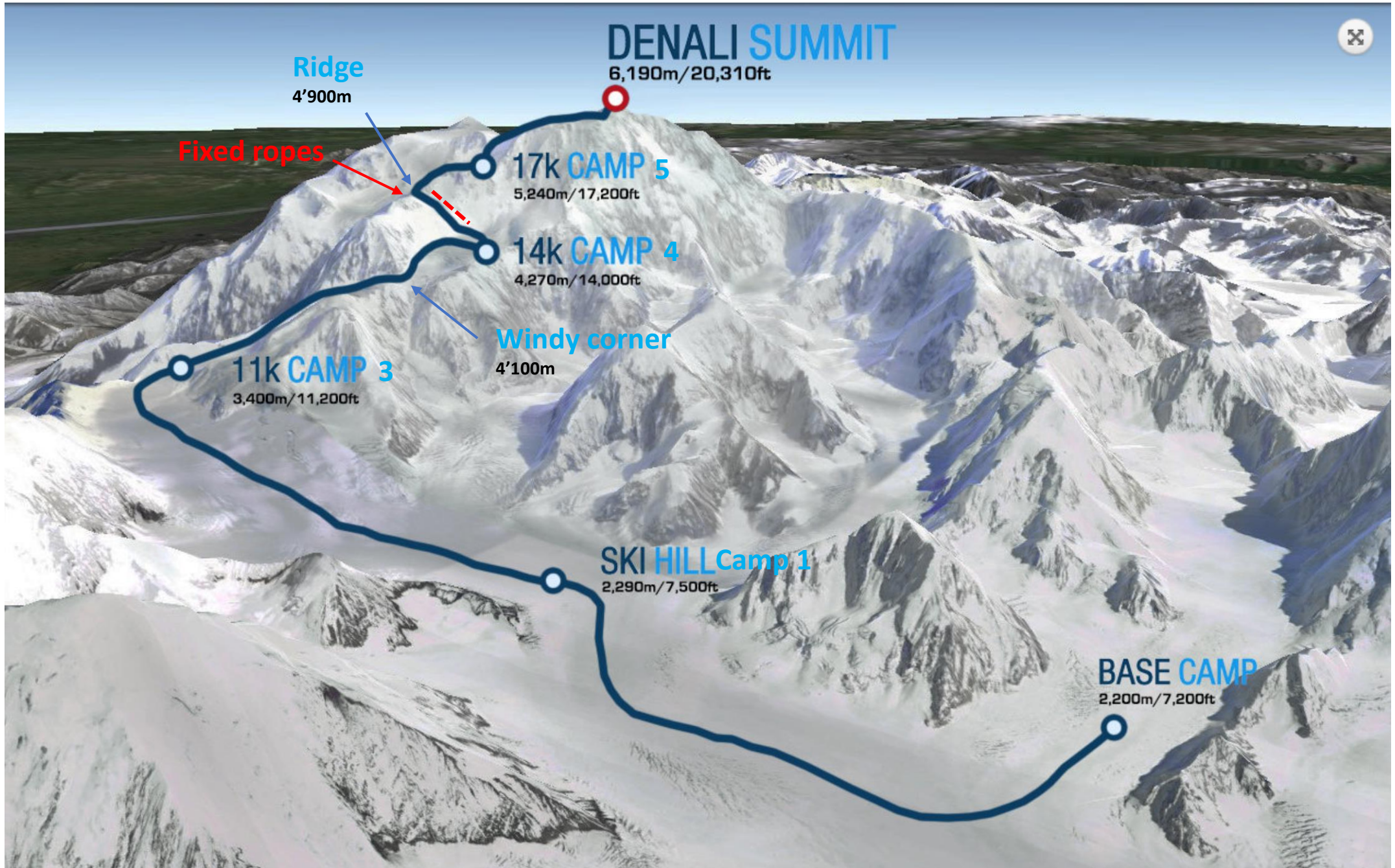
14k CAMP 4
4,270m/14,000ft

Windy corner
4'100m

11k CAMP 3
3,400m/11,200ft

SKI HILL Camp 1
2,290m/7,500ft

BASE CAMP
2,200m/7,200ft



Preliminary itinerary

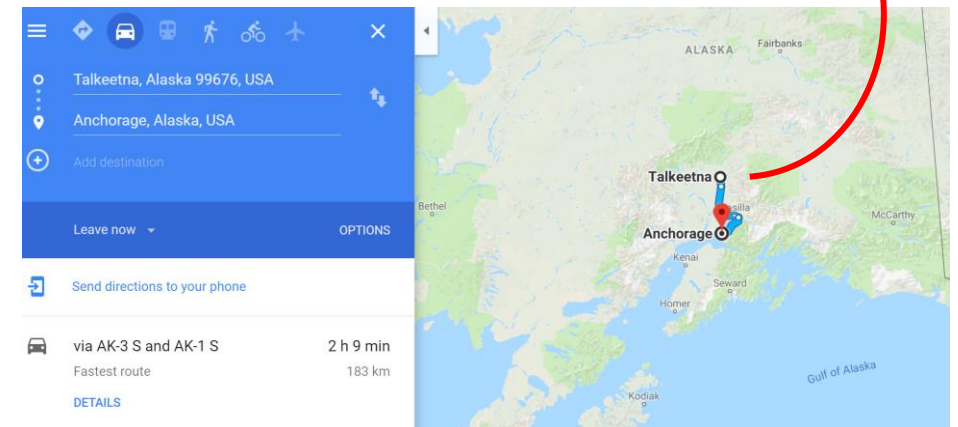
- Day 1 (May 25, Wed). Arrive to Anchorage
- Day 2. Anchorage / food shopping. Bus to Talkeetna. Complete NPS registration,
- Day 3. Fly to Kahiltna Base Camp (2'200m). Cache emergency food and gear. Rope up and take off to Camp 1. ➔ Single carry
- Day 4. Camp 1 (2'400m) to Camp 3 (3'400m) ➔ Single carry
- Day 5. Cache. Carry load to Windy corner (4'100m)
- Day 6. Move up to Camp 4 (4'300m). (+ collect load from Windy corner).
- Day 7 (May 31). Rest day / Collect load from Windy corner / Acclim. climb to ropes. (4'500m)
- Day 8. Carry load above fixed ropes (Ridge camp, 4'900m).

Wait for weather window

- Day 9. Move to Camp 5 (5'200m) (+ collect load from fixed ropes).
- Day 10. (June 3). Summit bid (6'190m) and return to Camp 5 / Camp 4.
- Day 11 Extra day
- Day 12. Extra day
- Day 13. Extra day
- Day 14. Extra day
- Day 15. Extra day
- Day 16. Camp 5 / Camp 4 to Kahiltna Base Camp (2'200m).
- Day 17. Fly to Talkeetna; return to Anchorage.
- Day 18 (June 12, Sunday). Fly home from Anchorage.



West Buttress Route (NPS Photo)



Distances summary

- Day 3. Kahiltna Base (2'200m; 7'200 ft) – Camp 1 (Ski hill 2'400m; 7'800 ft)
 - Elevation gain: 200m
 - Distance: 8-9km
 - Time: 4.5-6h
 - Single carry
- Day 4. Camp 1 (Ski Hill 2'400m; 7'800 ft) – Camp 3 (Motorcycle hill 3'400m; 11'000 ft)
 - Elevation gain: 1000m
 - Distance: 7.6km one-way
 - Time: 6-7h one-way
- Day 5. CACHE. Camp 3 (3'400m; 11'000 ft) – Windy corner 4'100m (13'500 ft) – Camp 3
 - *Elevation: +700m; -700m*
 - *Distance: 6.4km - roundtrip*
 - *Time: 6-7h - roundtrip*
- Day 6. MOVE up. Camp 3 (3'400m; 11'000 ft) – Camp 4 (Basin 4'300m; 14'200 ft)
 - Elevation gain: 900m
 - Distance: 4km one-way
 - Time: 5-7h one-way
 - Collect cache or do it another time (1.6km roundtrip, 1.5h, -200m, +200m)
- Day 7. Rest day / collect Cache / acclimatize until ropes
- Day 8. CACHE. Camp 4 (4'300m; 14'200 ft) – Ridge camp (4'900m; 16'200 ft)
 - *Elevation: +700m; -700m*
 - *Distance: 3.8km – roundtrip*
 - *Time: 5-7h*
- Waiting for weather window
- Day 9. MOVE up. Camp 4 (4'300m; 14'200 ft) – Camp 5 (High camp 5'200m; 17'200 ft)
 - Elevation: 900m
 - Distance: 3.2km – one-way
 - Time: 6-8h
 - Collect cache (otherwise, 3.8km roundtip, 5-7h, -200m, +200m)
- Day 10. Rest, prepare for summit bid
- Day 11. Summit. Camp 5 (5'200m; 17'200 ft) – Summit (6'190m; 20'320 ft) – Camp 5
 - Elevation: 1000m
 - Distance: 8km - roundtrip
 - Time: 9-12h or more
 - Depart at 7-10am
- Day 12-15. Extra days
- Day 16. Go down. Camp 5 (5'200m; 17'200 ft) – Kahiltna Base (2'200m; 7'200 ft)

Budget:

• Flight: to Anchorage (roundtrip)	1300 USD
• Shuttle: Anchorage – Talkeetna (roundtrip)	140 USD
• Flight: Talkeetna – Kahiltna Base Camp	585 USD
• Sledges: inclusive, free of charge	
• Denali registration fee:	375 USD
• Park entrance fee:	15 USD
• 2x hotel in Anchorage:	150 USD
• 2x hotel in Talkeetna:	150 USD
• Insurance:	200 USD
TOTAL	~3000 USD (2600 EUR)
+ Gear	
+ Food	

Frequently asked questions:

- <https://www.nps.gov/dena/planyourvisit/mountainfaqs.htm>
- Permits application: starts 1 Jan, 1500 permits per season

Flights: Vilnius – Anchorage

Vilnius (VNO) – Anchorage (Any)				Riga (RIX) – Anchorage (Any)			
1 adult Economy				1 adult Economy			
◀ Thu, 26 May ▶ ▶ Sun, 12 Jun ▶				◀ Thu, 26 May ▶ ▶ Sun, 12 Jun ▶			
	08:05 VNO	25h 28 —••—▶ 2 stops AMS, SEA	22:33 ANC		07:45 RIX	25h 48 —••—▶ 2 stops AMS, SEA	22:33 ANC
Operated by airBaltic, Delta				Operated by airBaltic, Delta			
Air France + KLM	06:20 ANC	20h 20 —••—▶ 2 stops MSP, AMS	13:40 ⁺¹ VNO	Air France + KLM	06:20 ANC	20h 15 —••—▶ 2 stops MSP, AMS	13:35 ⁺¹ RIX
Operated by Delta, airBaltic				Operated by Delta, airBaltic			
3 deals from 996 €				4 deals from 999 €			
Select →				Select →			

Flights: Zurich – Anchorage

Zurich (ZRH) – Anchorage (Any)

1 adult | Economy

◀ Thu, 26 May ▶

◀ Sun, 12 Jun ▶

IBERIA

07:15

ZRH

23h 02

→

20:17

ANC

2 stops LHR, ORD

IBERIA

13:30

ANC

18h 20

→

17:50⁺¹

ZRH

2 stops SEA, LHR

1 deal

774 €

Select →

Zurich (ZRH) – Anchorage (Any)

1 adult | Economy

◀ Wed, 25 May ▶

◀ Sun, 12 Jun ▶

14:05

ZRH

12h 35

→

16:40

ANC

1 stop KEF

13:30

ANC

37h 35

→

13:05⁺²

ZRH

2 stops SEA, KEF

9 deals from

975 €

Select →

Partly operated by Alaska Airlines

Team:

Paulius Pikelis



Location: Zurich

Occupation: Banking

Experience: Aconcagua, Kilimanjaro, Elbrus, Montblanc, Ironman, attempted Denali in 2019

Age: 33

Aurimas Mizgiris



Location: Klaipeda

Occupation: Dentist

Experience: Aconcagua, Meru Kilimanjaro, Kazbegi, Elbrus, attempted Denali in 2019

Age: 31

+ 2-3 extra people

Fun facts:

- It is imperative to your safety and survival that your team is skilled with **proper glacier travel, route finding, and crevasse rescue procedures**.
- All team members should have previous experience in the "expedition environment."
- Experience with winter camping in arctic type conditions is extremely valuable and should be considered mandatory.
- All registered climbers are required to go through the orientation at the Walter Harper Talkeetna Ranger Station. Official confirmation letter will include instructions to the leader on how to schedule an orientation appointment online. Teams **cannot** schedule an orientation until after they receive the confirmation letter. Appointments should be made as soon as practical, as orientation times fill up during peak periods.
- With a reasonable number of rest days and good weather, it is common for groups to summit in 15 to 18 days. Expeditions that give themselves 21 to 28 days are typically able to wait out adverse weather.
- You will need gear that will keep you warm in temperatures that can dip below -40 degrees F, 100 mph winds, heavy snowfall, freezing rain, blazing sun.
- Due to the many environmental difficulties including wind, visibility, altitude, and terrain, it is rare that we or anyone can help in a timely manner should you and your teammates find yourself in need of a rescue. For these reasons and others, we cannot stress enough the importance of maintaining self-sufficiency and planning for self-rescue.
- "Swapping" of partners or team members is not allowed. However, there is a provision to allow one climber to add into the expedition at least 30 days before the start of the climb. Please note that the fee from the cancelled climber is not transferrable to the new climber.
- There is a limit of 1,500 climbers on Denali from April 1 to August 1. There is not a daily or weekly limit, only a seasonal limit.
- The registration period begins January 1 of the current year.
- **A note on snow shelters:** All party members should have a plan for building a snow shelter in the event you get caught out in a storm or find yourself without your tent for any number of reasons. Snow shelters have saved countless lives on Denali. Both limbs and lives have been lost for inability to build a snow shelter. A small steel shovel is invaluable for digging into the hard ice found high on Denali or Mt. Foraker. Brush up on snow shelter construction prior to your climb and always allow for good ventilation while cooking.
- The average group size on Denali is 5-6 climbers. Teams may not exceed 12 members. Know your climbing partners in advance. Know their physical condition, limitations, skills, and their experience. Establish some sort of leadership or logical division of duties within your team.
- The typical climbing season on Denali starts in late April and continues through the middle of July. Colder temperatures and strong winds are common in May; June and July have milder temperatures and less wind, but often more snowfall.
- The busiest time of year on Denali is from the middle of May through the middle of June with several hundred climbers on the mountain in that time frame.
- The West Buttress and the Muldrow are the least technical ascent routes; the primary climbing difficulties are crevasses, steep ice and exposed ice-covered ridges and, of course, the environment. In recent decades, over 90% of climbers on Denali attempt the West Buttress. Climbers can expect to encounter several hundred others during the last week of May and first week of June.
- NPS rangers maintain fixed lines on the headwall above the 14,200-foot camp. All teams should be familiar with the equipment and techniques needed to safely ascend and descend these fixed lines. Additionally, teams should always be prepared to place their own snow and ice anchors in the event the fixed lines are damaged, buried, or missing entirely. The NPS rangers and mountain guides also install and maintain fixed snow pickets on the traverse between the 17,200-foot high camp and Denali Pass at 18,200 feet. This area has been the scene of many climbing injuries and fatalities, largely as a result of unprotected falls.

Appendix

Learn before the trip:

- Rescue scenarios:
 - Front person falls
 - Back person falls
 - Person conscious / unconscious
 - Pack and sled to be retrieved
 - Victim must be hauled
- Running belays
- Prussic knot (for sled)
- Astunke mazgas
- Sled brakes (knotted rope tied under the sled)
- Walking up and down with sledges
- Igloo, trenches, cave
- Kaip susidaro, juda ledynas
- Kada susiristi, kaip isdelioti lipikus, kaip daryti stotis is ledsriegiu ar snow pickets
- Judejimas per veja, kai uzpusto pedsakus per 10sec

Shuttle: Anchorage – Talkeetna – Anchorage

- Anchorage – Talkeetna (May 27, daily):
 - Train: 8:15 AM – 11:05 AM (90 USD)
 - Train: 9:15 AM – 12:15 PM (130 USD)
 - **Bus: 3:00 PM – 5:30 PM (70 USD)**
 - Private: any time, (300 USD up to 3 pax; 360 USD - 4 pax; next pax +75 USD)
- Talkeetna – Anchorage (Jun 11, daily):
 - **Bus: 11:00 AM – 1:30 PM (70 USD)**
 - Train: 5:00 PM – 8:00 PM (110 USD)
 - Bus: 5:45 PM – 8:30 PM (70 USD)
 - Private: any time, (300 USD up to 3 pax; 360 USD - 4 pax; next pax +75 USD)

<https://www.alaskatravel.com>

<http://talkeetnataxi.com>

Andrius Kirdeikis experience

- Labas dar karta. Pasistengsiu atsakyti kuo issamiau. Pradekim nuo komandos pasirinkimo. As visada uz tai, kad kopiant butum sau seimininkas. Jungiantis prie nepazistamu zmoniu gali buti sunku. Nezinai ju motyvacijos, pasiruosimo, patirties ir panasiai. Tuose kanluose buti yra nelengva, tai butu labia apmaudu, jeigu kazkas nusprestu suktis zemyn del keliu audros dienu. Plius moketi piniguz uz “gido” paslaugas tame kopime butu absurdas. Marsrutas aiskus ir visos rizikos suvaldomos jei turi bent kiek patirties ant ledynu ir stacių sniego slaitu. Tai siulyciau vaziuoti su savo draugais arba gerai issiaiskinti kas per kompanija lips.
- 1. Logistika. Labai svarbus dalykas yra uzsakyti skrydzius I Base Camp ant Kahiltnos ledyno ir atgal. Viskas vyksta Talkeetna miestelyje, apie 3 valandas kelio nuo Anchorage (kur atskrisite). I base camp skraidina gal 3-5 kompanijos, kainos labai panasios. Mes naudojomes <http://www.sheldonairservice.com/> paslaugomis ir buvom labai patenkinti. Uzsakyti skrydi reikia dar pries aplikuojant del leidimu kopimui (apie juos veliau). Kalbant su skrydziu operatoriais butina paklausk ar suteiks nakvyne diena pries ir diena po kopimo. Kai kurie suteikia tokia pasauga ir tai jums sutaupytu pinigų. Is Anchorage i Talkeetna nusigauti galima traukiniu (brangoka ir keistas tvarkarastis) arba taxi. Mes naudojomes Talkeetna taxi paslaugomis (<http://talkeetnataxi.com/>) ir viskas buvo super. 80\$ zmogui i viena puse, paima su busiku is kur nori ir kada nori. Pakeliui sustoja prekycentryje jei reikia apsipirkti maisto.
- 2. Permitai. Naujos kvotos 2018m kopimui bus pradetos dalinti si Rugseji ar Spali, dabar tiksliai nepamenu, bet visa info rasi <https://www.nps.gov/dena/index.htm>. Ju isduodama 1500 per metus ir suapliuoti reikia bent 3 men iki kopimo. Del permitu turi aplikuoti VISI KOMANDOS NARIAI. Aplikacijos anketoje prasys nurodyti komandos vadova (formalumas), kopimo datas, avia kompanija, kuria naudosite nusigauti i base camp, ankstesnius pasiekimus/kopimus, visus turimus mokymus, susijusius su kalnais. Reindzeriai gave visas paraiskas is visu komandos nariu svarstysi jusu “case” ir arba duos, arba neduos leidimu. Kaina apie 400 USD zmogui.
- 3. Roges nemokamai duoda avia kompanija. ESMIU ESME yra gauti rogutes su standzia jungtimi. T.y. kad rogutes temptum ne su virvele, bet su vamzdeliais (aliuminiais). Mes turejome tas paprastas ir labai suvargome. Kazkas tokio butu idealu: <https://www.skipulk.com/product/paris-pulk/>. Beda ta, kad tempiant su virve roges ciuožia i sona arba zemyn ir tai sukelia labai dideliu sunkumu, ypac leidziantis zemyn. Cia butu mano didziausias patarimas gauti kazka panasaus.
- 4. Marsrutas labai priklauso nuo laiko kada kopsite (geguze, birzelis) ir praejusios ziemos (sniego kiekis, kokio dydzio bergshrundas). Sezono pabaigoje atsiveria didziuliai plysiai ant ledyno ir judejimas imanomas tik nakti, kai viskas susala. Mes kopeme sezono pradžioje, tai plysiai nebuvo atsivere ir salyginai greitai galejome judeti. Techniskiausia vieta yra Head Wall ir pats West Buttres Ridge. Head wall tai segiesi i virve ir kapoji i virsu, reikia moketi tik su virve, ciuptuku ir/ar ziuraru dirbti. Pats West Buttres Ridge’as yra graziausia marsruto dalis, bet ir sudetingiausia. Beveik visur reindzeriai yra ikase snow picket’us, kad galetum judeti slenkancia sauga (running belay), bet mes ta atkarpa lipome be virves. Sketchy ir bet kokia klaida butu high consequences, bet judi greitai. Mano patarimas butu ta atkarpa eiti tik idealiu oru, nes butent ten siaucia nezmoniski vejai ir gali pridaryti daug bedu. Mes pirmu bandymu sukomes atgal ant ridge’o, nes vejai vos nenupute mano partneres. Judant su running belay neturetu kilti jokiu bedu. Siais metais pries didelio vejo temperaturos buvo -50 ant ridge’o ir -60 ant virsunes. Po to ne viena gelbejo su zveriskais forstbite’ais. Tai pasikartosiu dar karta – i high camp ir summit patarciau eiti tik esant labai gerom oro salygom. Ledkirtis ir lazdos butinos. Veliau einant i virsune man geriausiai veikia tokia taktika – vienoje rankoje ledkirtis, kitoje lazda.
- 5. 80% sito marsruto yra judejimas ledynu. Tai reikia suprasti ledyna, moketi judeti rysyje ir gelbejimo darbus.

Aurimas & Paulius – attempt in 2019

- <https://www.facebook.com/paulius.pikelis/posts/10156925874382771>

West Buttress

Difficulty Alaska Grade 2, 50-degree ice
Elevation gain 13,100' from Kahiltna Base Camp
Total time 14-24 days
Climbing time Up: 12-20 days. Down: 2-4 days
Season April to mid-July, June is best

The West Buttress of Denali is the most popular big mountain climbing route in all of Alaska. Of the 1,000 to 1,300 climbers that attempt Denali each season, 85 percent head for the West Buttress. Roughly half of them stand on the summit. The route is popular with apprentice and expert climbers alike. Less experienced climbers can test their skills at cold and altitude on a route that is non-technical and straightforward. More experienced climbers will find an excellent chance for acclimatization for harder routes, as well as a myriad of difficult variations should they be so inclined. The route is internationally famous as well. Each year hundreds of climbers come from around the world to attempt this Alaskan giant. Despite the inherent crowds, all climbers will find the West Buttress to be one of the most beautiful and scenic places imaginable. From the wide expanse of the Kahiltna Glacier, to the extensive views of the surrounding peaks and the unending view of the tundra to the north, the West Buttress is an outstanding climb and grand achievement for anyone.

FA: July 10, 13, 14, 1951; Bradford Washburn, William Hackett, Jim Gale, Henry Buchtel, John Ambler, Melvin Griffiths, Jerry Moore, and Barry Bishop.

History

For many years after Denali's first ascent, the Muldrow Glacier remained the only route attempted and climbed on the mountain. In the days before airplanes could land on glaciers, this was the only reasonable route to approach overland. And even as airplanes started flying onto the slopes around Denali, it was difficult to justify the expense and risk involved in

geological surveying. They established a camp at 15,400 feet, underneath the ice headwall that forms the route's crux. From here they fixed ropes all the way to 17,000 feet. The hard ice proved difficult and required chopping steps up 800 feet of 50-degree blue ice. On July 10 they continued up the long traverse to Denali Pass. Having been up the upper section before from prior climbs on the Muldrow, they walked up to the summit in four and a half hours. Bishop, Butchel, Griffiths, and Moore eventually reached the summit on July 13 and 14.

Thus a new generation of Alaskan climbing was born—one that eliminated the long and grueling approaches to allow climbers to focus more on climbing itself. Washburn's vision had become a reality that will be enjoyed for many generations to come.

In January 1967, three bold Alaskan climbers made the first winter ascent of Denali via the West Buttress. Early in their trip one member, Jacques Batkin, in their team of eight, died in a crevasse fall. Dave Johnston, Art Davidson, and Ray Genet summited on February 28. A vicious

trying a new route, Bradford Washburn, who had been surveying and capturing aerial photography of the Alaska Range since 1936, spied a route on the western slopes of the mountain that might provide a safe and easy way to the summit. It would also be significantly shorter than the Muldrow route if a team was flown in to the glacier at the base of the route. Washburn published his findings in the 1947 *American Alpine Journal*.

In 1951, a group of climbers from Colorado teamed up with Washburn and two of his partners to try this new route. Jim Gale and Bill Hackett had climbed with Washburn on earlier Muldrow trips. The Colorado climbers were Dr. John Ambler, Barry Bishop, Dr. Henry Buchtel, Dr. Melvin Griffiths, and Jerry Moore. Other than to open a new route up Denali, the team hoped to accomplish detailed geological survey work in order to complete the now famous Boston Museum of Science Mount McKinley map.

The team flew in with expert glacier pilot Terris Moore, inventor of the indispensable wheel ski for airplanes. The plan was to have one team flown on to the Kahiltna Glacier, while another team came overland from Wonder Lake, up the Peters Glacier, and over Kahiltna Pass to meet the other party. On June 18, 1951, Washburn, Gale, Buchtel, and Hackett were flown to 7,650 feet on the Kahiltna Glacier. They moved up to 10,000 feet and waited for the other team to meet them here. Meanwhile the military made an airdrop of over 2,500 pounds of food and equipment. Washburn and his team climbed Kahiltna Dome (12,525 feet) for surveying purposes, making its first ascent. The rest of the team, consisting of Ambler, Bishop, Griffiths, and Moore, slowly made their way up the Peters Glacier. Bishop and Moore climbed Peters Dome (10,600 feet) and placed surveying equipment on its summit for Washburn. This was a first ascent of this peak as well. Finally on June 30, the team crossed over Kahiltna Pass to meet the rest of the team.

Washburn, Hackett, and Gale continued up new ground on July 4. The rest of the team provided support and continued their

storm enveloped the mountain and they were trapped at Denali Pass for six days. They had little food or fuel to melt water, but with persistence and determination, they all endured, creating one of the most renowned survival stories in the history of mountaineering. Art Davidson wrote about the epic in his book *Mountains of the West: Winter Ascent of Mt. McKinley*.

The first solo ascent of the West Buttress and Denali was made by Naomi Uemura. Uemura was one of the world's greatest explorers of the 1930s. In January of 1984 he came to Denali to attempt a solo winter climb as training for a solo climb of Mount Vinson in Antarctica. Uemura reached the summit on February 12, but became lost in a storm on the descent and disappeared. His high-camp was found at 17,200 feet and on the summit was found the Japanese and American flags that he carried, but after extensive searches his body was never found.

In more modern times, American climber Chad Kellogg accomplished the first one day round-trip ascent from the Kahiltna Base Camp. In a marathon effort,

Kellogg left Base Camp at 2:15 A.M. on June 17, 2004 and reached the summit 14 hours and 22 minutes later. He returned to Base Camp the next morning at 2:10 A.M.

Strategy

Occasionally climbers who acclimatize well and have unusually good weather are able to make the summit and back in under two weeks. This is the exception, not the norm, and average parties should plan on 18-21 days on the mountain. For a higher probability of success, a longer trip can be planned.

The West Buttress is normally climbed in full expedition style. Double-carrying loads and the "climb high, sleep low" concept are commonly employed. In addition, plastic sleds are used to help ferry gear on the flatter sections of the glacier. When placing a glacier cache, make sure to bury it at least three feet deep and place a 10-foot or longer wand to mark it. Caches on the lower glacier can melt out fast and ravens frequently dig up and destroy poorly buried supplies.

Make sure each campsite is well fortified and protected from the elements. On the Kahiltna Glacier and at the 14,000-foot Camp, it is best to place your tent on the

and practice your glacier skills.

Day 3: The load carrying schedule for the Kahiltna generally depends on the month and the temperature. Early season climbers will want to travel during the warmth of the day, while June and July climbers will travel at night to beat the intense daytime heat. Leave Base Camp and single-carry the gentle glacier to 7,800 feet. Some parties double-carry this section.

Day 4: Carry a load to the next camp, either 9,800 feet or 11,000 feet.

Day 5: Move up to next camp.

Day 6: Rest Day.

Day 7: Carry a load to either just before or just after Windy Corner (13,000 to 13,500 feet) or all the way to 14,200 feet.

Day 8: Move camp to 14,200 feet.

Day 9: Rest day or pick up cache below.

Day 10: Rest day or pick up cache below.

Day 11: Carry a load to 16,200 feet or 17,200 feet.

Day 12: Move camp to 17,200 feet.

Day 13: Rest day or pick up cache at 16,200 feet.

Days 14-17: Summit days.

Day 18: Return to 14,200 feet or 11,000 feet.

Day 19: Return to Kahiltna Base Camp. Check in with the Base Camp Manager, dig up your emergency cache, and prepare for your flight.

Day 20: Fly to Talkeetna and check out with the NPS.

Day 21: Return to Anchorage and fly home.

Gear

Take standard glacier travel gear. Mechanical ascenders are useful for ascending the fixed lines.

Camps

These are frequently used camping locations. Many more camp locations exist and are used by climbers. The expansive

level of the glacier and build up snow walls around it. Digging a tent-site deep into the glacier will only ensure that you get completely buried during a heavy wind and snow storm, while the snow tries to return your hole to the level of the glacier. Above the 14,000-foot Camp, snow caves are preferable to tents, although they can be much more time-consuming. Make sure your tent-site is completely bomb-proof. Skis and snowshoes are commonly used along the Kahiltna. It's best if the entire party sticks with one method or the other. Skis are by far better; they are faster and safer over crevasses. Descending between load carries becomes a quick and fun trip, rather than more slogging.

Sample Itinerary

Day 1: Arrive in Anchorage. Complete last minute shopping and drive to Talkeetna. Check in with air service and if you arrive early enough, complete NPS registration at the Ranger Station.

Day 2: Register with NPS and prepare for flight. Fly into Kahiltna Base Camp and obtain fuel and sleds. Cache your emergency gear and food. Motivated parties may be already organized and can ropeup, and take off. Otherwise, relax, acclimatize,

Kahiltna Glacier provides near infinite camping opportunities, although climbers tend to group together in the following locations.

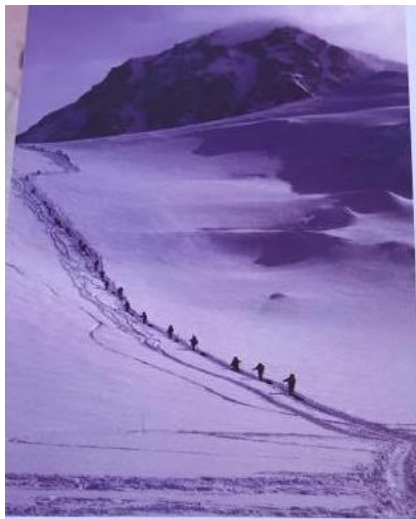
Ski Hill (7,800 feet): Actually at the base of Ski Hill, some climbers will refer to this as the "Northeast Fork" camp because of the confluence of the Northeast Fork of the Kahiltna. The main camping area is located closer to the 7,700-foot contour of the map. There are some major east-west crevasses that run through the area. Each year climbers must cross huge sagging snow-bridges. It is not unusual to see old snow walls of camps sinking down on these as well. As with every camp, be sure to probe the area well.

Kahiltna Pass Camp (9,800 feet): This broad, relatively crevasse-free area is used as an intermediate camp between Ski Hill and the 11,000-foot Camp.

The 11,000-foot Camp (10,900 feet): This is the last flat area at the end of the main Kahiltna. Beware; this northern part of the Kahiltna Glacier is a sink for bad weather and snow. It can snow six feet here while Base Camp receives less than a foot. Make sure you mark well any caches you leave here. Many parties decide to leave their skis here. If so, plant your skis around your cache and tape your wands atop your skis.

The 14,000-foot Camp (14,200 feet): The location of a seasonal Park Service outpost with several ranges here over the course of the season. This is the best place to rest, acclimatize, and prepare a strategy for the summit attempt. There are two latrines maintained by the Park Service that should be obligatorily used if you camp here.

Ridge Camp (16,200 feet): This is an okay spot to stash gear or make an extra stop in acclimatizing. The back (north) side of the ridge just above the col above the fixed lines affords a small area to dig tent platforms or a good snow-cave (there are actually permanent snow-caves here). It also allows a quick retreat back down the fixed lines should the weather turn bad. This spot can be exceptionally windy and brutal during a storm.



Route

The route is divided into five sections for a total distance of 16.5 miles.

Kahiltna Base Camp to Ski Hill (junction of Northeast Fork of the Kahiltna) (5.5 miles)
From Kahiltna Base Camp, head west down Heartbreak Hill. The reason for this moniker will become evident on your way back out. Keep to the right and well off the airstrip. At the bottom of the hill (6,750 feet) turn right (north) onto the main fork of the Kahiltna. Below the west face of Mount Frances is a small icefall. This is generally best skirted on its left side. Sometimes parties will take a direct path through it, but this is not recommended. Above the icefall, the best path can vary year to year. Normally, it is best to head northeast staying toward the center of the glacier. Often times, however, there is a good path just right of the southeastern ridge coming down from Pt. Farine (Pt. 9,300 feet). Either way, regain the center of the glacier and head due north to the base of Ski Hill and the junction of the Northeast Fork (7,800 feet).

Ski Hill to 11,000-foot Camp (4 miles)
Ascend Ski Hill, which has two distinct rises. Above, the glacier rises gradually to 10,000 feet. A good side trip can be made here by climbing Mount Capps (Pt. 10,790) above Kahiltna Pass. This easy peak has excellent 360-degree views, including a good overview of the route ahead and an inspiring view into Peter's Basin and the Father and Son's Wall. The main climbing route makes a sharp turn to the east and ascends into a basin below what is referred to as Motorcycle Hill. Just before arriving

West Buttress

at camp (10,900 feet), there is avalanche danger from a series of seracs up and right.

11,000-foot Camp to 14,000-foot Camp (2.75 miles)
Many parties will leave their snowshoes or skis at the 11,000-foot camp and walk from here in crampons. Some will continue on skis however all the way to the 14,000-foot camp. This is a matter of personal choice. The skiing above here is much more difficult and steeper. Ascend the 700-foot Motorcycle Hill. Every year there are serious crevasses on the hill and near its base. At the top of the hill, the route crosses the crest of the Alaska Range for a brief bit and overlooks the awesome Father and Son's Wall to the north. From the top of the hill, traverse up and under the prominent rocks to the right. Then climb steeply up Squirrel Hill to where the route flattens out below the massive west face of the West Buttress proper. At the top of Squirrel Hill (12,300 feet), insidious crevasses run in several different directions so extra prudence is necessary. Continue by making a long southeasterly traverse underneath the west face of the West Buttress. Be wary of rock-fall from the face above. Climb toward

Windy Corner crossing two large crevasses. One of these crevasses was used as a camp on the first ascent. This spot should be considered more as an emergency camp location. It can provide adequate protection from wind and weather. Windy Corner was named by Bradford Washburn who encountered 90 mile-per-hour winds here. There is a good resting spot in the rocks at the top of the hill (13,200 feet), before continuing around the corner. Another great side-trip is an ascent of Pt. 13,350. This little knoll is a quick 15-minute jaunt and lends an excellent view to the surrounding area.

The east side of Windy Corner has some of the worst crevasse problems on the route. The route makes an exposed side-hill traverse above an icefall and over several crevasses. Be very attentive through this area as it is the site of many accidents. Continue east and drop down slightly into the basin below. Occasionally people will camp here, but due to its proximity to Windy Corner and its exposure to rock-fall, it is not recommended. Continue east up the broad slopes trending left of the major crevasses. Make the final flat traverse to the 14,000-foot Camp.

foot Camp (14,200 feet). This is a good place to rest for a few days and acclimatize while devising a summit strategy. Most parties will carry a load to the 17,000-foot camp and return here to wait for good weather for the final summit bid.

A good side trip here is to go visit the "Edge of the World Rock." Although many people won't, it is highly recommended to rope up to walk out to this amazing overlook. Walk due south from camp heading toward the prominent rock outcrop on the edge of the glacier. Boulder to the exposed top of the rock for hero pictures.

14,000-foot Camp to 17,000-foot Camp (1.75 miles)
The route now turns north up toward the long icy headwall that gains access to the ridge of the West Buttress proper. Climb up 35-degree snow slopes and over a couple large crevasses at the top of the first rise. The angle backs off a little, then becomes steeper as it approaches the ice face and the fixed lines. This hill below the fixed lines is frequently skied. The fixed lines are installed and maintained by the National Park Service each season. Below the fixed lines is a huge bergschund (15,400 feet) that provides an excellent safe spot to take a break, get ready, and then wait in line for your turn on the fixed lines. It is not totally unheard of for climbers to bypass the fixed lines and climb the 50 to 55-degree ice beside them. Climb or ascend this slope until the col at 16,200 feet is reached. Ascending traffic should use the right fixed line and descending traffic should use the (climber's) left fixed line. It is recommended to clip an ascender onto the fixed line and push it up the line for safety as you climb the ice. A good technique for descending the fixed line is to first clip into the line with an ascender. Wrap the fixed line twice around your back arm and with your other hand, hold your ascender open. Walk down the ice using friction from your arm wrap to control your speed and close the ascender when you need to stop.

The most interesting and scenic part of the route is the climb up the crest of the West Buttress. Start up the ridge looking for

a prominent rock prow called Washburn's Thumbs. Climb left (north) of the crest to often fixed lines here as well that help with stay on or near the rocky crest of the ridge until it flattens out at 17,200 feet. Traverse into the large flat area known as the Crow's Nest and start work on a good protected campsite or snow-cave.

17,000-foot Camp to the Summit (2.5 miles)
The next section of the route is the long and exposed traverse to Denali Pass. Informally known as the "Autobahn," this is the site of numerous accidents. Head up toward a prominent rock outcrop on the slope above. Traverse left underneath this feature and onto the 35 to 40-degree rising traverse to the pass. The National Park Service has installed fixed pickets on this section in recent years. Reach the pass at 18,200 feet. Turn south and climb the right side of the 40-degree slope on the left (east) side of the crest. When the slope becomes less steep, continue up near the ridge crest, heading for the right side of Archdeacon's Tower. A small descent leads to the "Football Field" at 19,300 feet. Traverse southeast across this flat expanse to the final slope heading up to the summit ridge. Climb this short slope to Kahiltna Horn (20,120 feet). Continue east along the sharp and exposed summit ridge to the top.

Descent

Descend the route. Be especially careful when descending from Denali Pass. Climbers tend to be cold, exhausted, and altitude sick. Use prudence and running-belay if necessary. Most parties will spend an additional night at the 17,000-foot Camp to rest before descending to the 14,000-foot Camp. While it is possible to descend all the way to Base Camp from 17,000 in a day for motivated parties, many parties will take a more relaxed two to three day pace. Remember there are still many hazards and difficult sections to reverse on the descent.



Gear (1/4)

CLIMBING EQUIPMENT	Aurimas	Paulius	Total		Comment
Dideli karabinai (large carabiners)	5	5	10		Petzl
Karabinas rogems	1	1	2		Petzl
Ascender (zumaras)	1	1	2		Petzl
Prusikai	2	2	4		
Pulley (ratukas)	1	1	2		Petzl
Micro-traction	1	1	2		Petzl
Rope grab (astunke)	0	0	0		Neprireike, nera kur naudoti. Ant virviu negalima
Apraisai (seat harness)	1	1	2		
Daisy chain	1	1	2		
Savisaugos virve	2	2	4		
Snow pickets	1	1	2		60cm
Ice screws	1	1	2		17cm, untralight petzl
Lazdos (trekking poles)	1	1	2		CT Alta Via
Ice axe	1	1	2		CT Alpin Tour L, 70cm
Ice axe leash	1	1	2		
Salmas	0	0	0		neprireike
Ciklopas	0	0	0		neprireike
Batteries for cyclop	0	0	0		neprireike

Gear (2/4)

GROUP GEAR	Aurimas	Paulius	Total		Comment
Rope 9-10.5mm	0	1	1	REI	40m, low stretch rope, 9mm-10.5mm. Pirksim 60m, dynamic, dry-core
Rope for pulling sledges x6mm	6	6	12		12m, 6mm
Rope for breaking x6mm	1.5	1.5	3		3m uzteks per akis
Rope for buckling x3mm	0	0	0		Mazom kilpelem. po 3 metrus
Probe pole	0	1	1		Optional, nepanaudojom
Straps for sledges (uzkabint maisa ant rogiu)	0	10	10		5 buckles vienam
Tent	1	0	1		Marmot Thor 3.
Snow anchors	0	0	0		Toughstakes, nepanaudojom
Wands	0	20	20	Sheldon	Panaudojom gal 5 kokias
Sledges	0	2	2	Sheldon	Butu gerai su standzai jungtimi kazkaip
White gas (galons)	0	2	2	Sheldon	2 for climb, 1 BC
MSR XGK EX gas stove	0	1	1		1x MSR XGK EX – High Camp, jei labia prastai butu
Reactor gas stove	1	0	1		1x Reactor – susitaupo laiko labai, daug kas tik sita nesei
Liquid fuel pump	0	1	1		
Liquid fuel bottle 0.6L	0	0	0		
Liquid fuel bottle 1L	0	3	3		30 oz (0.9L). 3 su savim, 1 BC palikt
Plastmasinis piltuvelis	1	0	1		
Pjuklas	0	1	1		MSR
Kastuvas	1	1	2		MSR
Bliudas	1	0	1		
Lenta pasidet dujinei	1	0	1		
Two-way radio (walkie-talkie)	0	0	0	Sheldon	Nereikia, nesigirdi nieko, prognoze lieva
Satelite phone	1	0	1		Garmin InReach expedition+
Sun battery	0	1	1		Anker PowerPort Solaw W21
Power bank	0	2	2		
REPAIR KITS					
Ski straps	2	0	2		Ilgiausiai kokius gausit (650mm)
Platmasiniai zips	0	1	1		Neprireike
Duct tape	0	1	1		
Repair kit thermarest	0	1	1		
MSR XGK Expedition Service Kit	0	1	1	REI	pagal modeli - expedition repair kit
Reactor service kit	1	0	1	REI	
Repair kit for tent	0	0	0		

Gear (3/4)

FOOTWEAR	Aurimas	Paulius	Total		Comment
Batai	1	1	2		Scarpa Phantom 8000
Kates	1	1	2		Grivel G12 ir G14
Socks	4	4	8		Lorpe Primaloft Polartec
Snowshoes	0	2	2	Sheldon	
Booties	1	1	2		Belenskaip komfortas
BOTTOM					
Triusikai	3	3	6		
Lengvos termo kelnes (miegot)	0	0	0		
Merino vilnos 250 kelnes	1	1	2		
Siltos termo kelnes	1	1	2		
Trekingo kelnes (softshell)	1	1	2		
Siltesnes kelnes	1	1	2		Montane Primaloft
Windstopper kelnes (hardshell)	1	1	2		Montane Alpine Pro
Pukines kelnes	0	0	0		Nera taip salta, tik svoris
TOP					
Maike	2	0	2		
Lengvas termo virsus	0	1	1		miegui
Merino vilnos 250 virsus	1	1	2		
Siltas termo virsus	1	1	2		
Fleece megztinis	1	1	2		
Paprastas trekingo virsus	0	0	0		Softshell jacket
Lightweight insulated jacket	1	1	2		lengva pukine striuke
Windstopper virsus	1	1	2		Montane Alpine Pro
Pukine striuke	1	1	2		

HANDWEAR	Aurimas	Paulius	Total		Comment
Liner gloves	1	1	2		windstopperiniai lineriai
Primaloft pirstines (insulated shell gloves)	2	1	3		1 extra per team
Softshell gloves (rimtos pirstines)	1	2	3		Marmot BTU. 1 extra
Expedition mittens	2	1	3		1 extra per team
HEADWEAR					
Buff	3	3	6		
Kepure nuo saules su snapeliu	1	1	2		
Facemask	1	1	2		
Wool/synthetic ski hat	1	1	2		
Glacier glasses (4 cat)	1	1	2		
Ski goggles	1	1	2		
Nose guard	1	1	2		Kazka su dect tape pasidaryt reikes

Gear (4/4)

PERSONAL EQUIPMENT	Aurimas	Paulius	Total		Comment
Kuprine	1	1	2		kasdieniams rubams numest angare
Flight cover bag	1	1	2		Optional, skrydziui tik
Kuprine	1	1	2		bent 80L
Duffel bag	1	1	2		bent 100L
Trash contractor bags (storu)	15	0	15		
Sleeping bag	1	1	2		Marmot CWM Membrain
Inflatable sleeping pad	1	1	2		Xtherm
Foam pad	1	0	1		patogu atsisest siaip
Pee bottle (1-1,5L)	0	0	0		Nereikalingas
Water bottles	1	2	3	REI	1L
Water bottle parkas	1	2	3	REI	
Thermos	1	1	2		1L
Thermos	1	1	2		0.75L
Spoon	1	1	2		
Bowl	1	1	2		nereikalingas, is maiseliu valgai
Knife (opinel)	1	1	2		
Mug	1	1	2		
Lietuvos veliava	0	1	1		
Higiena					
Toilet paper	1	1	2		
hand sanitizer	0	1	1		
toothbrush	1	1	2		
toothpaste	1	1	2		
wet wipes	1	1	2		
Sunscreen	1	1	2		
Lipscreen	1	1	2		
Hand warmers	0	0	0		Nereikejo
Feet warmers	0	0	0		Nereikejo
Toe warmers	3	3	6	REI	Priklauso nuo batu. Nereikejo

MEDICAL	Aurimas	Paulius	Total		Comment
Pastiliu nuo gerkles	Sau	sau			
Diamox	20	20			tablets
Vaistai nuo skausmo (Ibuprofen)	12 tableciu	12 tableciu			
Pleistrai compeet	sau	sau			
Rutulinis pleistras	1 rulonas	1 rulonas			
First aid kit	1	0			
Leidziamo ir geriamo dexamethazone	1	0			
Stipriu antibiotiku. 4 skirtingus	4	0			
Kitu vaistu	1	0			Nuo uzdegimu (Nimesil), viduriavimo, akiu lasai (snow blindness), antibiotikai nuo kristaliuku)